

Kenyon's Grist Mill — Economic Environment Report, 2026Q2

Usquepaugh, Rhode Island · Published 23 August 2026 · Method v1.0 · 70/70 series retrieved, 0 failed · Generated automatically from BLS, Federal Reserve, Census and BEA data

§0 Vintage & provenance

Every figure in this report was retrieved from a federal statistical agency on 2026-08-23. Nothing is estimated, modelled or filled in except where explicitly marked. Raw responses are snapshotted so this report reproduces exactly as published even after agencies revise.

Two placeholder inputs. The dollar figures throughout apply real, fetched percentage changes to an assumed **\$500,000** annual controllable cost base and to **provisional group weights**. Both live in `config/series.yaml`. Replace them with figures from the books and every dollar in this report re-renders correctly — the percentages do not change. Group weights remain provisional pending the soap/milled-goods cost separation identified as a Priority 1 gap in the business diagnostic.

HOW MUCH DETAIL DO YOU ACTUALLY NEED?

This report is built in layers so that different readers can stop at different depths. Nobody needs to read all of it every quarter.

TWO MINUTES

§1 Dashboard and §2.1 headline. Tells you whether anything broke and roughly what it cost. If everything is green, stop here.

TEN MINUTES — THE OWNER'S READ

Add §2.2 roll-up, §2.4 cost bridge, and §12 actions and watch-outs. This is the intended default: what moved, what it cost, what to do.

HALF AN HOUR — QUARTERLY PLANNING

Add §3A producer prices, §4 energy, §5 labor and §9 policy. Read before pricing decisions, budget setting, or a supplier renegotiation.

REFERENCE — AS NEEDED

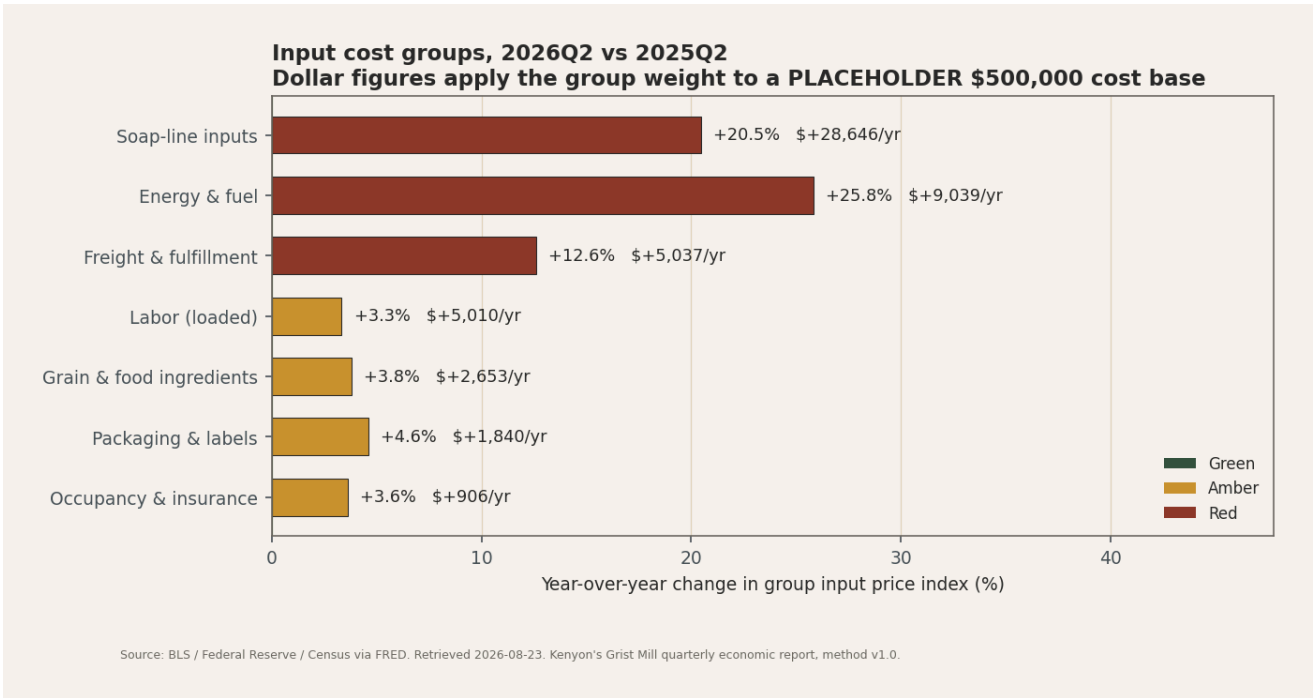
§A gaps and §B source manifest. For when someone asks where a number came from, or a

lender, grant funder or buyer wants to see the workings.

The honest answer to “how deep should I go?” is that the ten-minute read is enough nine quarters in ten. The value of the deeper sections is that when something does move, the detail is already there and dated — you are not starting a research project in the middle of a problem.

§1 Dashboard

KICI — WEIGHTED INPUT COST +11.0% YoY · +5.5% QoQ · level 150.3	KICI-MILL (EX-SOAP) +6.7% YoY · level 137.9	ANNUALISED COST IMPACT \$+53,130 on placeholder base
INDUSTRY MARGIN SPREAD -18.7 pts, 4-quarter change	NO. 2 DIESEL PPI +80% YoY · largest single mover	BANK PRIME RATE 6.75% -0.8% YoY
RI AVG HOURLY EARNINGS \$37.53 +3.5% YoY	CONSUMER SENTIMENT 48 -12.7% YoY	



V1.2 Input cost groups ranked by year-over-year change, coloured by threshold band. Dollar annotations apply each group weight to the placeholder cost base.

§2 Executive summary

2.1 · THE HEADLINE

An energy shock is moving through this business by an indirect route. Diesel producer prices are up **80%** year over year, and the pass-through is landing hardest not on the mill but on the soap line — inedible tallow and fats, a biodiesel feedstock that tracks diesel, are up **40%**. The weighted input cost index rose **+11.0%**, of which **5.7 points** came from soap-line inputs alone. Meanwhile our industry's own selling prices are flat (**+0.6%**), which means the milling sector is absorbing this rather than passing it on.

2.2 · DOMAIN ROLL-UP

Domain	Metric	2026Q2	QoQ	YoY	\$ impact/yr	Status	\$
Producer prices (composite)	KICI	150.3	+5.5%	+11.0%	\$+55,030		\$3A
Producer prices ex-soap	KICI-Mill	137.9	—	+6.7%	—		\$3A

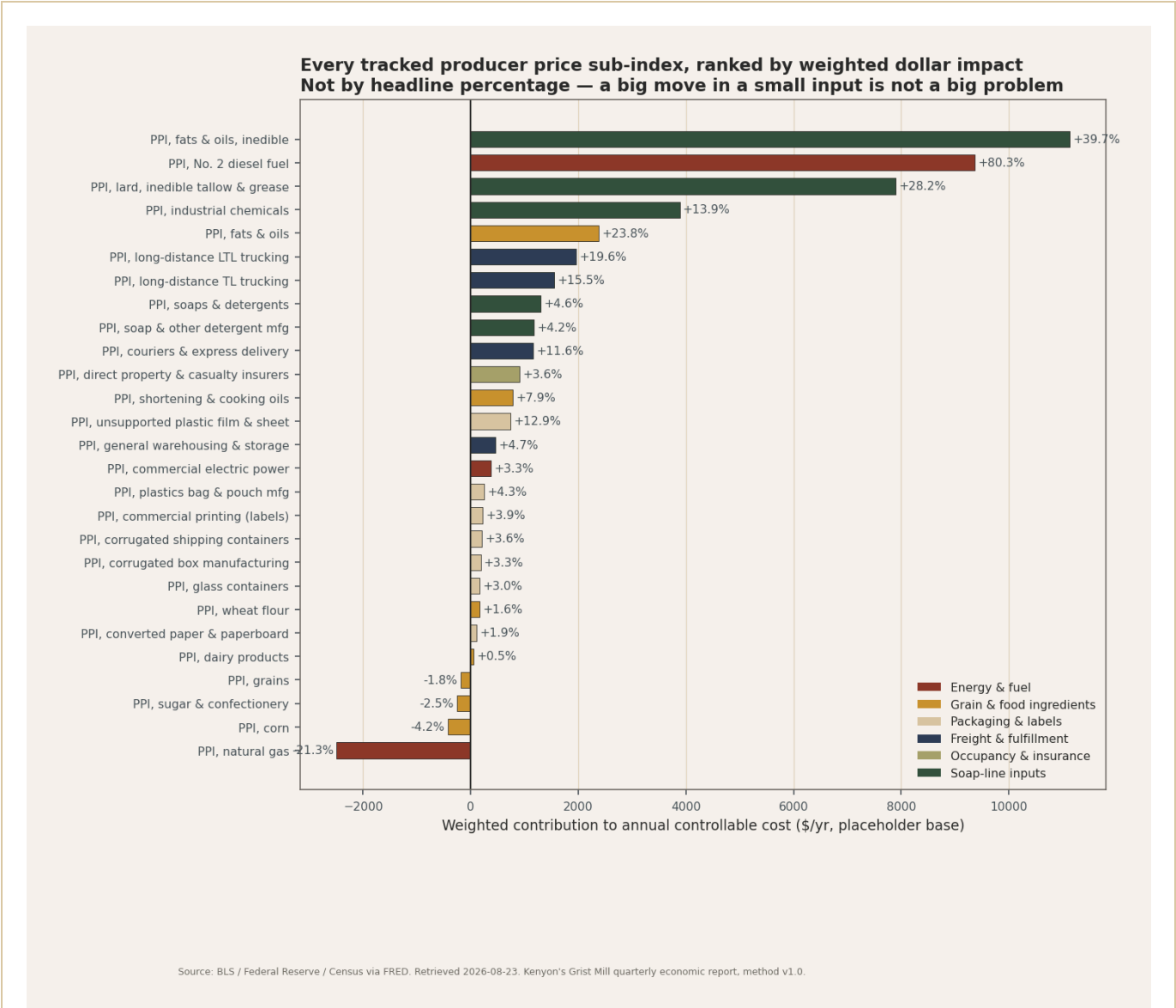
Domain	Metric	2026Q2	QoQ	YoY	\$ impact/yr	Status	\$
Soap-line inputs	group index	+20.5%	—	+20.5%	\$+28,646		\$3A
Energy & fuel	group index	+25.8%	—	+25.8%	\$+9,039		\$3A
Freight & fulfillment	group index	+12.6%	—	+12.6%	\$+5,037		\$3A
Labor (loaded)	group index	+3.3%	—	+3.3%	\$+5,010		\$3A
Grain & food ingredients	group index	+3.8%	—	+3.8%	\$+2,653		\$3A
Packaging & labels	group index	+4.6%	—	+4.6%	\$+1,840		\$3A
Occupancy & insurance	group index	+3.6%	—	+3.6%	\$+906		\$3A
Demand — our shelf category	CUSR0000SAF111	366.8	+0.0%	+2.3%	—		\$7
Demand — food & bev store sales	MRTSSM445USS	85,510.0	+1.0%	+1.5%	—		\$7
Demand — RI tourism proxy	RILEIH	60.4	-2.8%	-1.5%	—		\$7
Demand — consumer sentiment	UMCSENT	48.0	-13.3%	-12.7%	—		\$7
Capital — bank prime rate	DPRIME	6.8	+0.0pp	-0.8pp	—		\$8
Labor — RI avg hourly earnings	SMU44000000500000003	37.5	-1.2%	+3.5%	—		\$5

2.3 · PRODUCER PRICE SUMMARY

The four numbers: economy-wide final demand PPI **+5.7%**; our industry's output prices (flour milling) **+0.6%**; our weighted input composite **+11.0%**; and the spread between the last two, which moved **-18.7 points** over four quarters. A negative spread movement of this size means the industry is eating cost increases rather than recovering them at the wholesale price.

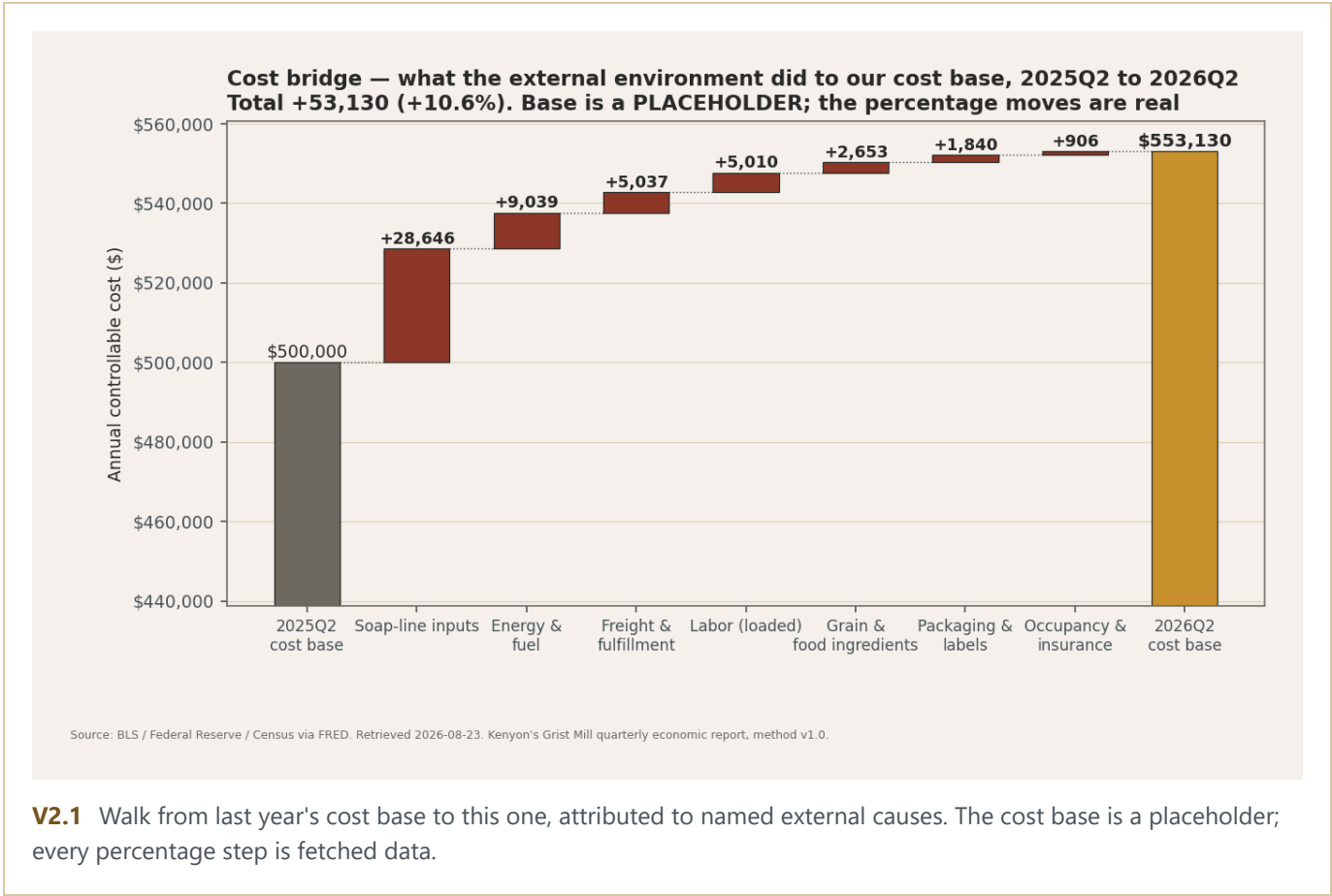
Top movers (ranked by YoY)	Series	YoY	QoQ
No. 2 diesel fuel	WPU057303	+80.3%	+37.8%
fats & oils, inedible	WPU0641	+39.7%	+22.2%
lard, inedible tallow & grease	WPU06410132	+28.2%	+9.9%
fats & oils	WPU027	+23.8%	+14.4%

Top movers (ranked by YoY)	Series	YoY	QoQ
long-distance LTL trucking	PCU484122484122	+19.6%	+13.4%
long-distance TL trucking	PCU484121484121	+15.5%	+8.5%
Declining	Series	YoY	QoQ
natural gas	WPU0531	-21.3%	-59.1%
corn	WPU01220205	-4.2%	+2.3%
sugar & confectionery	WPU025	-2.5%	-0.5%
grains	WPU012	-1.8%	+2.8%



V2.3 / V3A.2 Every tracked producer price sub-index, ranked by weighted dollar contribution rather than headline percentage. This ordering is deliberate: a 30% move in something worth 0.4% of spend is trivia.

2.4 · THE COST BRIDGE



2.5 · PASS-THROUGH AND PRICING

Holding contribution margin flat against a **+11.0%** input cost increase requires either a price increase or an absorbed margin loss of roughly **+\$53,130** annually at the placeholder base. Because the milling industry's own output prices are flat, a straight pass-through would place our shelf price above where the category is moving.

NARRATIVE SLOT — TO BE COMPLETED BEFORE PUBLICATION

This block requires internal data the pipeline cannot reach: SKU-level costs, current shelf prices, and the competitive price ladder. Until the Tier 3 collections exist, the pass-through requirement can be stated in aggregate (above) but not allocated across SKUs. See §5 Known Gaps.

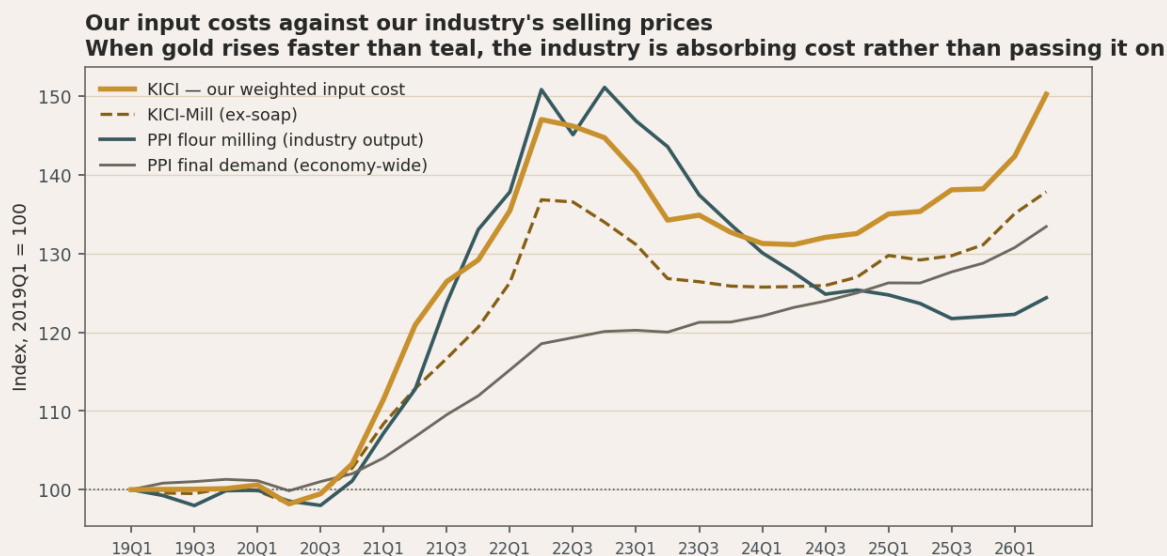
2.6 · THREE THINGS TO DO BEFORE NEXT QUARTER

- 1. Re-quote the soap-line supply.** Tallow and inedible fats are up 40% YoY and 22% in the quarter alone. On provisional weights this is roughly **+\$28,646** a year, the single largest external cost movement facing the business. *Owner: ____ · By: ____*

2. **Confirm whether soap should still be carried at this scale.** The diagnostic already flagged soap as 63.6% of COGS with unknown profitability. This quarter's data says its input costs are now also the most volatile thing in the portfolio. Those two facts together are a decision, not an observation. *Owner:* ____ · *By:* ____
3. **Start the Tier 3 collections.** Contracted grain prices, our own kWh, and a competitive shelf-price audit. None exist; all are needed before the next report can convert percentages into per-unit decisions. Ten minutes a quarter. *Owner:* ____ · *By:* ____

§3A Producer price detail

33 tracked sub-indexes across eight groups. Every series key was validated against BLS's own `wp.series` and `pc.industry` name files before use — several plausible-looking codes decode to entirely different commodities, and guessing them is the most common way a report like this goes quietly wrong.



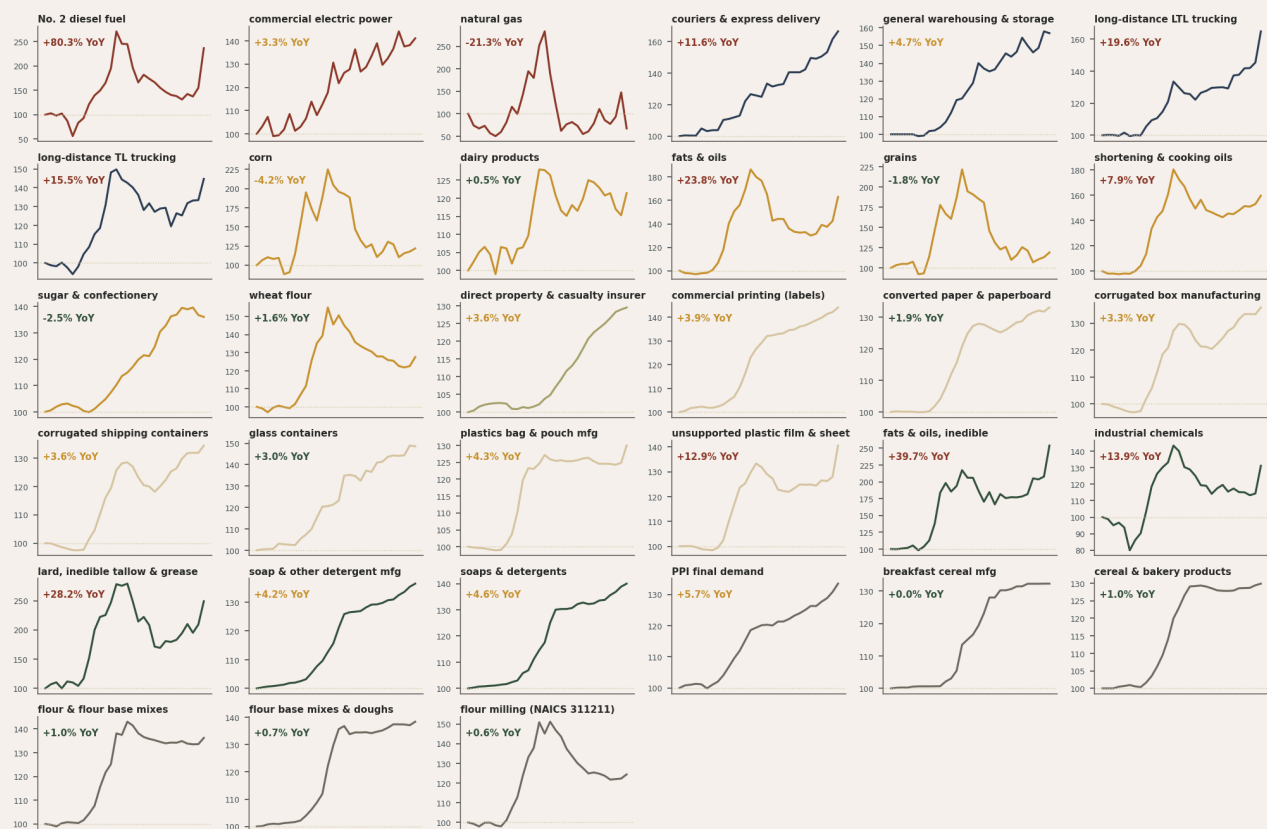
Source: BLS / Federal Reserve / Census via FRED. Retrieved 2026-08-23. Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic report, method v1.0.

V3A.1 Our weighted input cost against our industry's selling prices and the economy-wide final demand index, all rebased to 2019Q1 = 100. The 2026 divergence between the gold and teal lines is the central finding of this quarter.

WEIGHTED CONTRIBUTION TO THE COMPOSITE

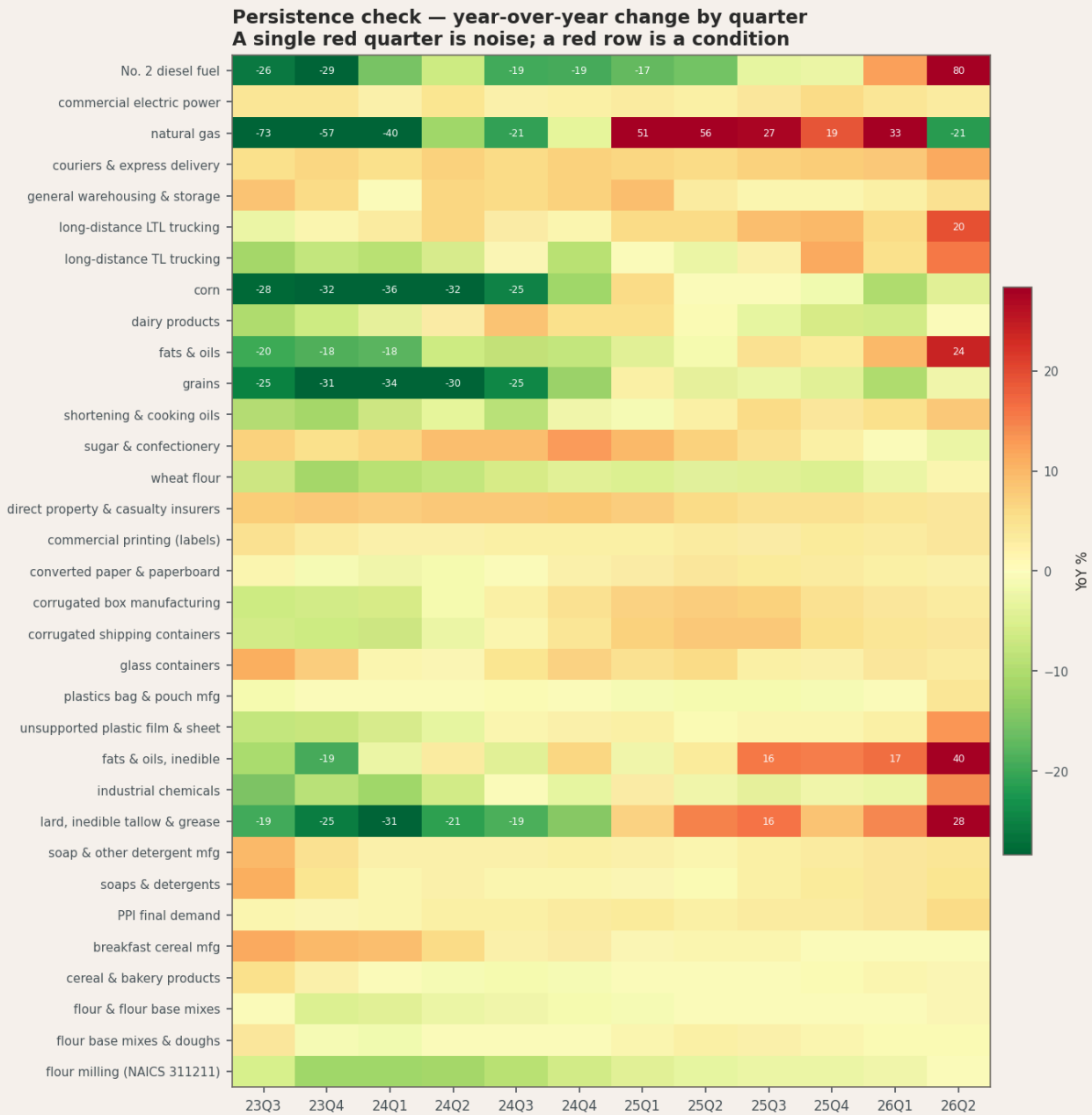
Group	Weight	YoY change	Contribution (pts)	\$/yr
Labor (loaded)	30%	+3.3%	+1.00	\$+5,010
Soap-line inputs	28%	+20.5%	+5.73	\$+28,646
Grain & food ingredients	14%	+3.8%	+0.53	\$+2,653
Packaging & labels	8%	+4.6%	+0.37	\$+1,840
Freight & fulfillment	8%	+12.6%	+1.01	\$+5,037
Energy & fuel	7%	+25.8%	+1.81	\$+9,039
Occupancy & insurance	5%	+3.6%	+0.18	\$+906
TOTAL	100%	+11.01%	+11.01	\$+53,130

Every tracked producer price index, 2019Q1 = 100, through 2026Q2



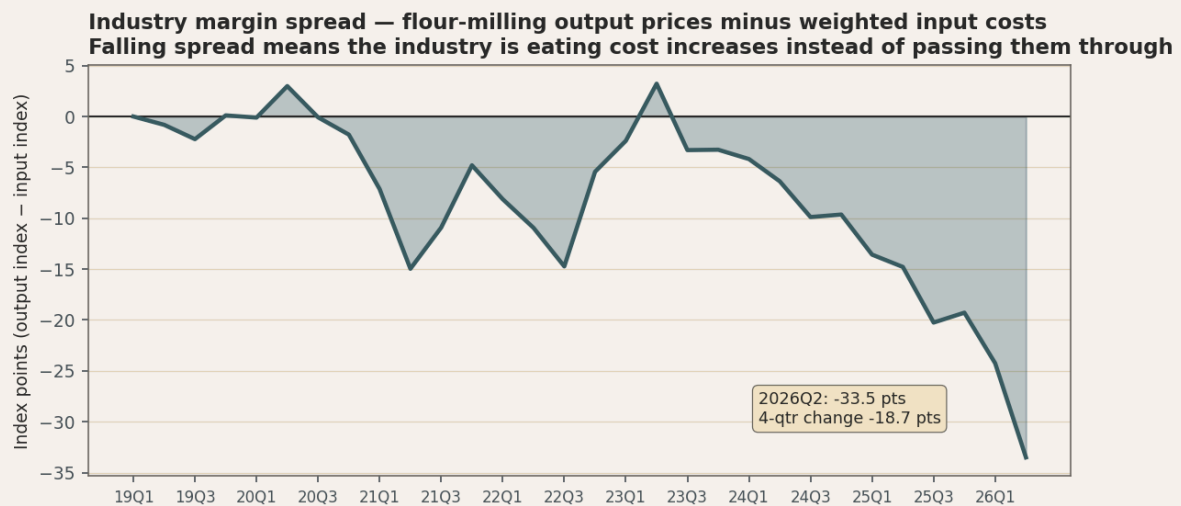
Source: BLS / Federal Reserve / Census via FRED. Retrieved 2026-08-23. Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic report, method v1.0.

V3A.3 Every tracked producer price index rebased to 2019Q1 = 100, coloured by cost group, with year-over-year change and threshold band. Grey panels are output/industry indexes rather than inputs.



Source: BLS / Federal Reserve / Census via FRED. Retrieved 2026-08-23. Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic report, method v1.0.

V3A.4 Persistence check. A single red quarter is noise; a red row is a condition that has been running long enough to act on.



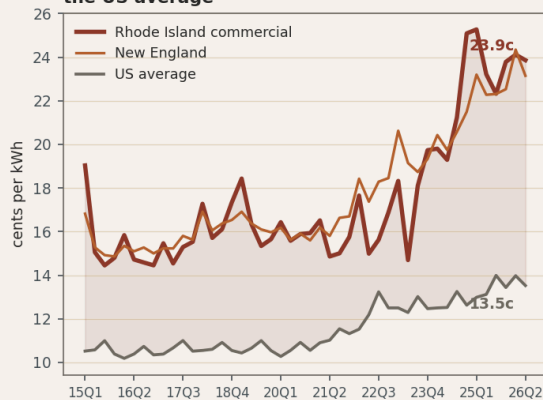
Source: BLS / Federal Reserve / Census via FRED. Retrieved 2026-08-23. Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic report, method v1.0.

V3A.5 The industry margin spread — flour-milling output prices minus our weighted input cost index. The sharp 2026 fall is the milling sector absorbing input costs rather than recovering them.

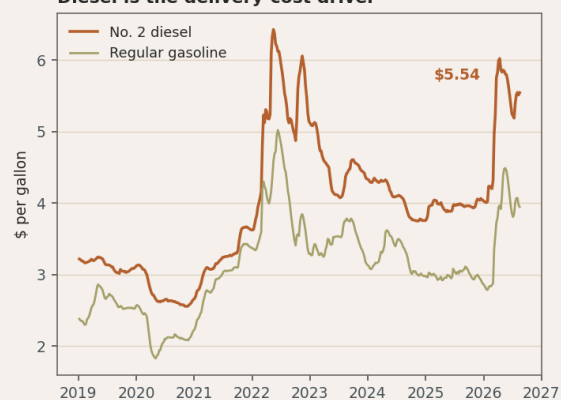
§4 Energy & utilities

The gap flagged in the last report is now closed. Rhode Island commercial electricity runs at **23.9¢/kWh** against a US average of **13.5¢** — a **76% premium**, up from 54% two years ago. This is a structural disadvantage that is getting worse, and it is invisible in any national index.

RI commercial power costs 76% above the US average

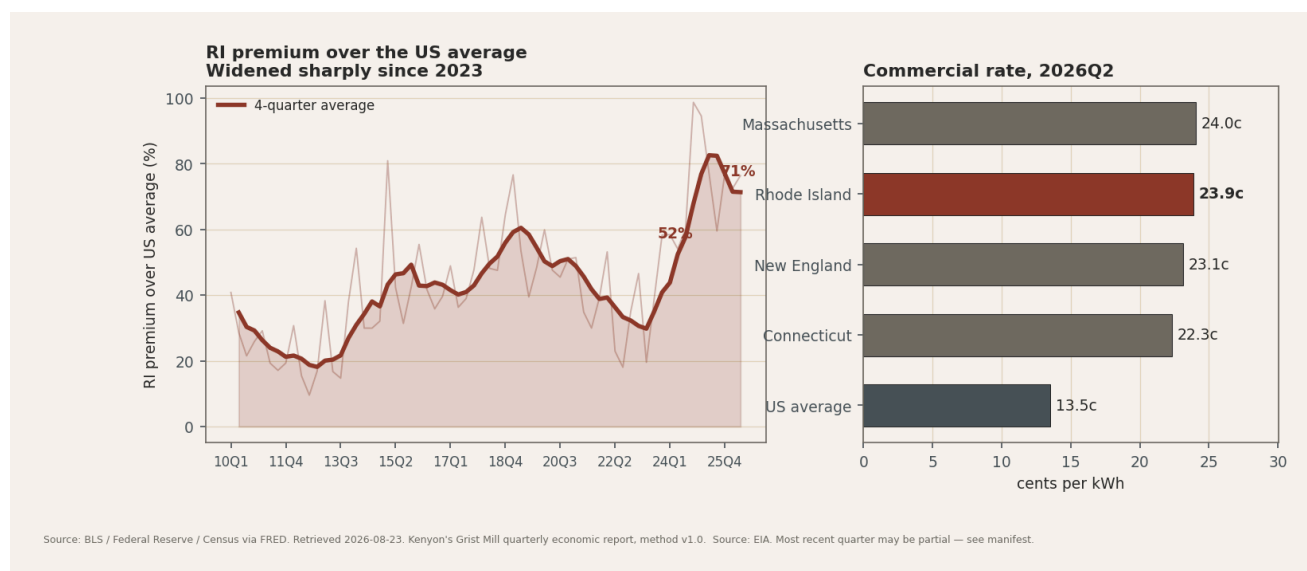


New England (PADD 1A) retail fuel Diesel is the delivery-cost driver



Source: BLS / Federal Reserve / Census via FRED. Retrieved 2026-08-23. Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic report, method v1.0. Source: U.S. Energy Information Administration (EIA), retrieved via open bulk endpoints.

V4.1 / V4.3 Rhode Island commercial electricity against New England and the US average, and New England retail fuel. Now sourced from EIA rather than national proxies.



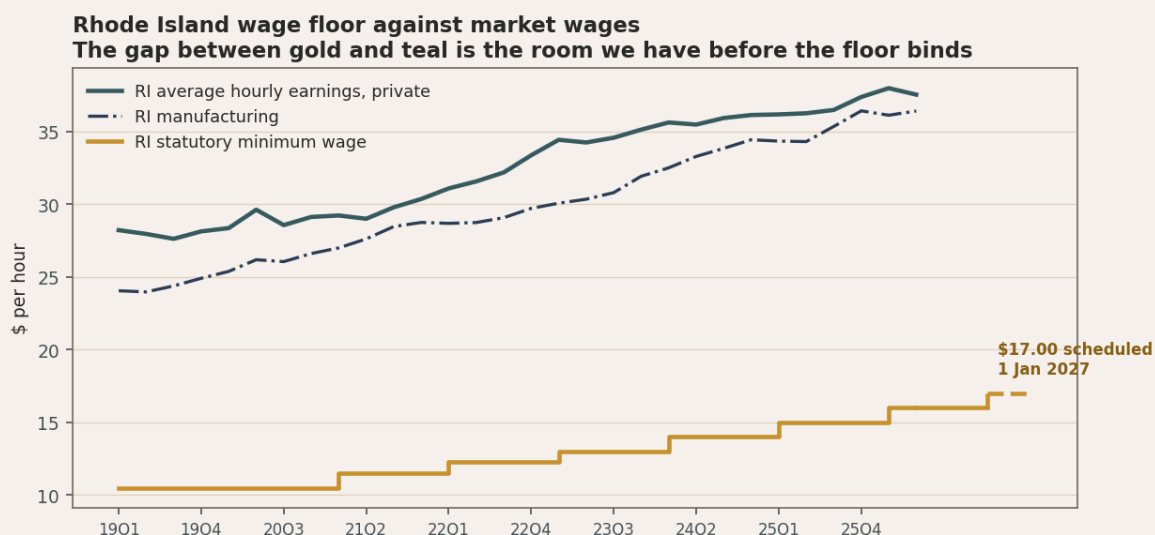
V4.2 The Rhode Island premium over the national average, four-quarter average, and the current commercial rate against regional peers. RI sits at the top of the most expensive region in the country.

Three things follow from this. First, RI is the most expensive commercial rate in New England (**23.9¢** vs MA 24.0¢, CT 22.3¢) — so a national benchmark understates the position by roughly three-quarters. Second, the RI rate itself rose only **+2.8%** year over year, so electricity is not this quarter's problem; the premium is a level problem, not a rate-of-change problem. Third, natural gas actually **fell 29%** while New England diesel rose **+46%** to **\$5.54/gal** — the two have decoupled, and only one of them drives delivery cost.

Partial quarter: 9 EIA series have only 2 of 3 months in 2026Q2 — EIA publishes state energy data on a longer lag than BLS publishes producer prices. Energy figures for the report quarter are provisional and will firm up next quarter.

What is still missing: our own kWh and therms. With price alone we can say Rhode Island is expensive. With usage we could decompose the bill into rate, weather and consumption effects and tell you which of the three actually moved. That takes entering 24 months of utility bills once.

§5 Labor



Source: BLS / Federal Reserve / Census via FRED. Retrieved 2026-08-23. Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic report, method v1.0.

V5.1 The Rhode Island statutory wage floor against market wages. The scheduled \$17.00 step on 1 January 2027 is drawn dashed because it is legislated but not yet in effect.

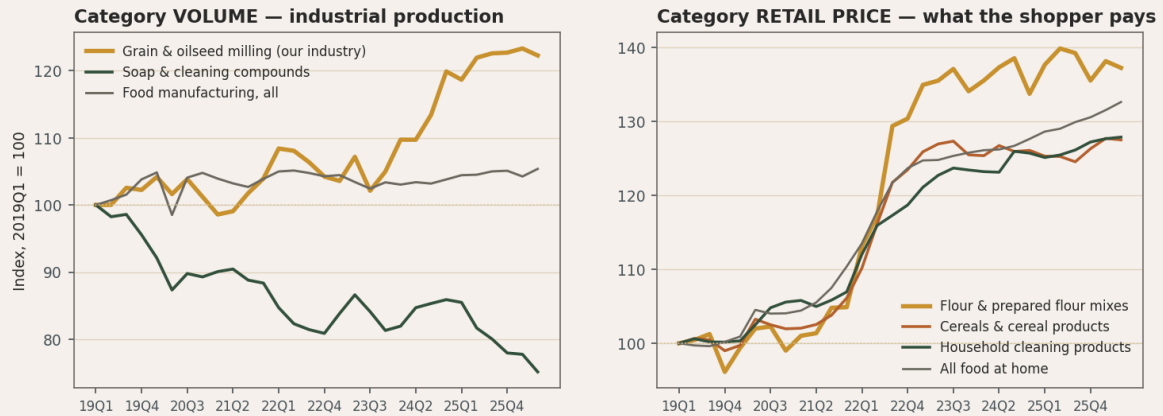
Rhode Island's minimum wage rose to **\$16.00** on 1 January 2026 and is legislated to reach **\$17.00** on 1 January 2027. RI is also the last state with a Sunday and holiday premium pay requirement, which for a weekend-traffic retail site is a material and unusual cost that no national wage series captures.

§7 Market demand for our product categories

Cost data says what we pay. This section says whether anyone wants what we make. It separates **volume** (how much of the category the country is actually producing), **price** (what the shopper pays at retail), and **channel** (where the category is bought) — because those three can and do move in opposite directions.

The finding that matters most this quarter. Since 2019, industrial production in grain and oilseed milling — our own NAICS code — is up about **22%**, and has climbed steeply since 2023. Over the same period, production of soap and cleaning compounds is down roughly **25%** and still falling (**-8.0%** YoY). One of our two product lines sits in a growing category. The other sits in a shrinking one.

Read alongside the diagnostic's finding that soap is 63.6% of COGS with unknown profitability, and this quarter's finding that soap inputs are the most volatile thing we buy, that is three independent signals pointing at the same question.



V7.1 Left: category volume, from Federal Reserve industrial production indexes. Right: category retail price, from CPI item-level series. Volume and price are different questions and are shown separately on purpose.

7.1 • CATEGORY VOLUME AND PRICE

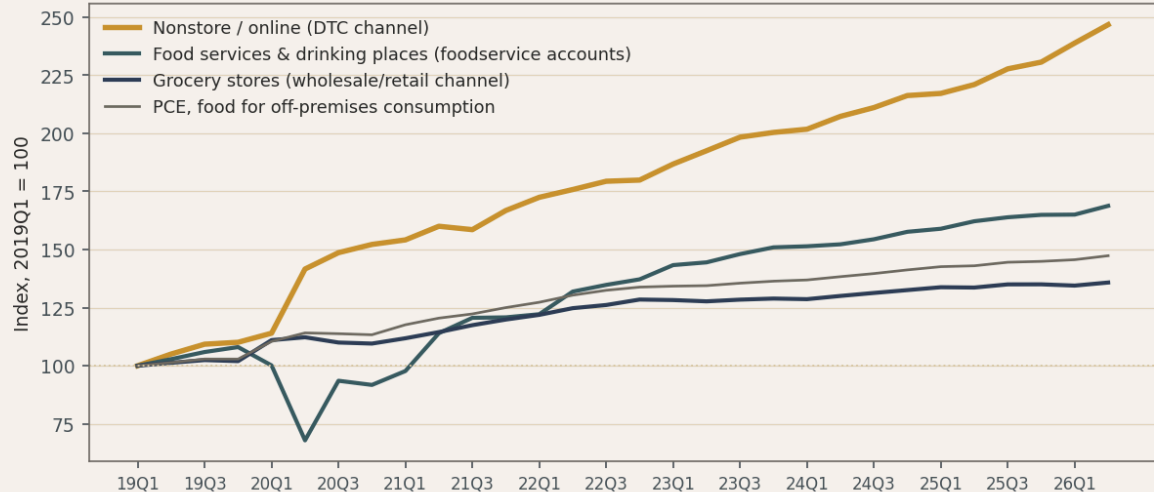
Series	Key	2026Q2	QoQ	YoY	Why it is here
Industrial production, grain & oilseed milling	IPG3112S	124.7	-0.8%	+0.3%	<i>THE category volume series for the milled-goods line. NAICS 3112 — our own industry.</i>
Industrial production, soap & cleaning compounds	IPG3256S	78.5	-3.4%	-8.0%	<i>Category volume for the soap line</i>
Industrial production, food manufacturing	IPG311S	105.0	+1.1%	+0.8%	
CPI, flour & prepared flour mixes	CUUR0000SEFA01	324.9	-1.0%	-1.9%	<i>The single most on-point demand series available for cornmeal, johnnycake meal and pancake mixes</i>
CPI, cereals & cereal products	CUUR0000SEFA	290.1	-0.2%	+1.8%	
CPI, breakfast cereal	CUUR0000SEFA02	284.0	-0.7%	+2.4%	
CPI, household cleaning products	CUUR0000SEHN01	154.0	+0.2%	+1.9%	<i>Retail price backdrop for the soap line</i>

Series	Key	2026Q2	QoQ	YoY	Why it is here
Retail sales, grocery stores (\$M)	MRTSSM4451USS	77,123.3	+1.0%	+1.6%	Wholesale/retail channel demand proxy
Retail sales, nonstore retailers (\$M)	MRTSSM454USS	138,947.3	+3.3%	+11.7%	DTC / online channel demand proxy
Retail sales, food services & drinking places (\$M)	MRTSSM722USS	102,291.0	+2.3%	+4.1%	Restaurant/foodservice channel — the bakery and restaurant accounts
E-commerce share of retail sales (%)	ECOMPCTSA	17.1	+0.6%	+4.9%	
PCE, food & beverages for off-premises consumption (\$B)	DFXARC1M027SBEA	1,567.9	+1.2%	+3.0%	
RI leisure & hospitality employment, NSA (000s)	RILEIHN	61.9	+10.4%	-2.0%	Not seasonally adjusted on purpose — the seasonal swing IS the signal for a seasonal site business

7.2 · CHANNEL DEMAND

Nonstore retail — the closest public proxy for the DTC channel — grew **+11.7%** year over year, against **+1.6%** for grocery stores and **+4.1%** for food services. The channel growing fastest in the wider economy is the one the diagnostic found to be 1.3% of our revenue. That is an observation about the market, not yet a recommendation about us: a channel growing nationally is not the same as a channel we can profitably serve, and the diagnostic was explicit that wholesale is where our revenue and our leak actually are.

Where the category is being bought — channel demand since 2019
Each line is a channel this business either sells into or could



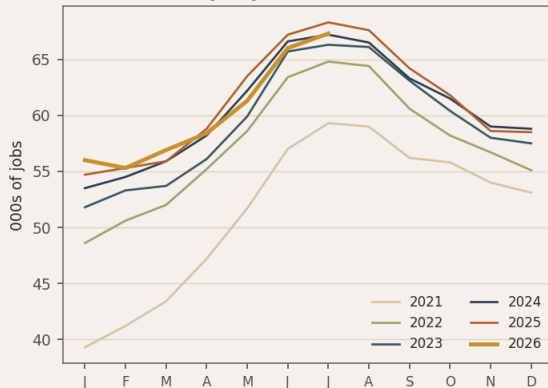
Source: BLS / Federal Reserve / Census via FRED. Retrieved 2026-08-23. Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic report, method v1.0.

V7.2 Channel demand since 2019, all rebased to the same quarter so the lines are comparable. Each is a channel this business either sells into or could.

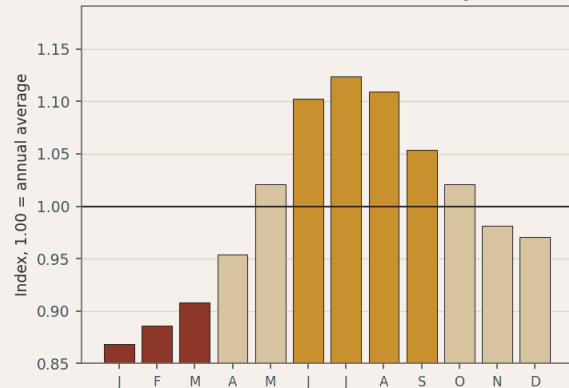
7.3 · SEASONALITY OF THE SITE BUSINESS

Shown deliberately **not** seasonally adjusted. For a seasonal destination business the swing is the signal, not noise to be removed. The Rhode Island visitor economy runs roughly **12% above** its annual average in July and **13% below** it in January — the site business has about a five-month window, and the mail-order and wholesale lines have to carry the rest.

RI leisure & hospitality by month
(not seasonally adjusted)



Seasonal index of the RI visitor economy
The window the site business actually has

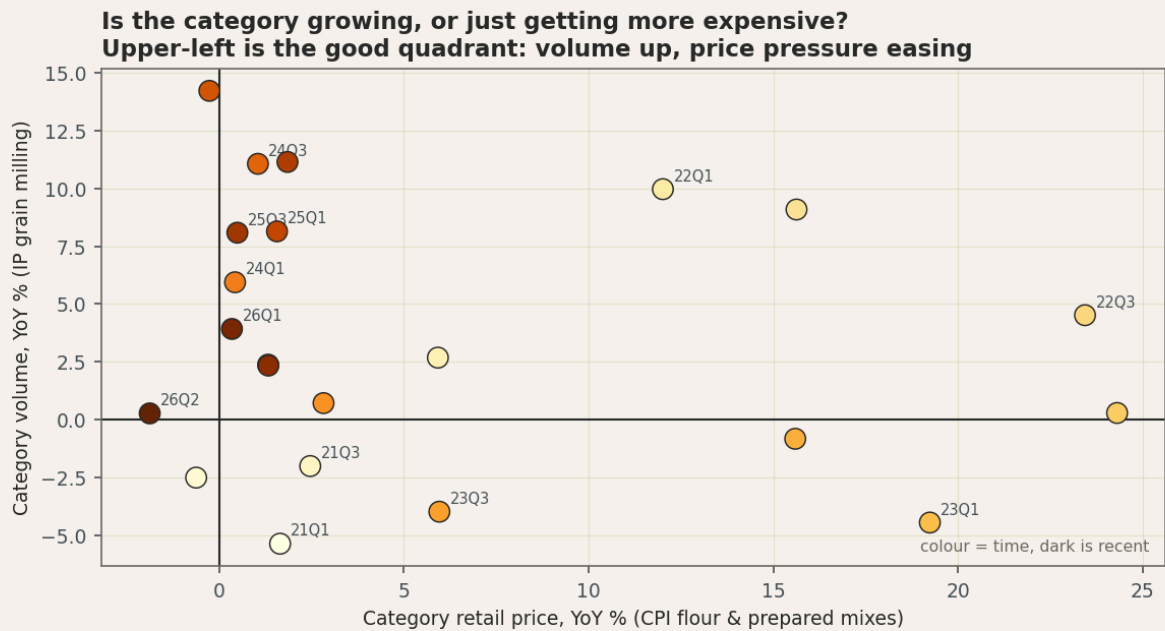


Source: BLS / Federal Reserve / Census via FRED. Retrieved 2026-08-23. Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic report, method v1.0.

V7.3 The Rhode Island visitor economy by month and its seasonal index. Gold months are above the annual average; red months are meaningfully below it.

7.4 • GROWING, OR JUST MORE EXPENSIVE?

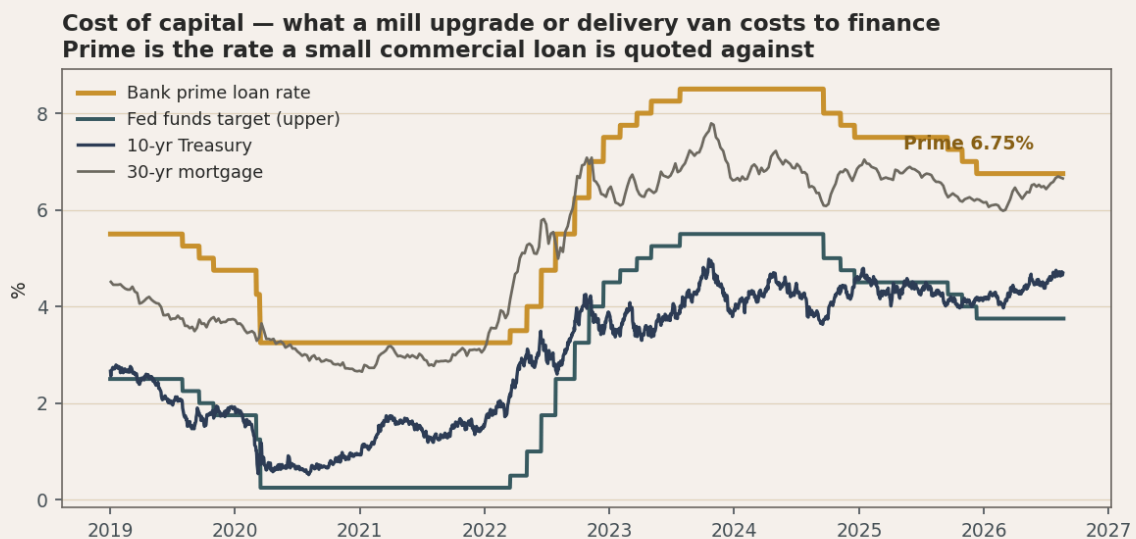
The quadrant chart separates real category growth from price inflation. Upper-left is the favourable position — volume rising while retail price pressure eases.



V7.4 Category volume growth against category retail price growth, quarterly since 2021. Colour runs light to dark with time, so the recent path is the darkest points.

What this section still cannot tell you. Every series here is a national category aggregate. None of it measures demand for *heritage stone-ground* products, for Rhode Island johnnycake meal specifically, or for our brand. That requires the competitive shelf-price audit and our own channel-level sales history — both Tier 3 collections that do not yet exist. Category demand sets the weather; it does not tell you how your own crop is doing.

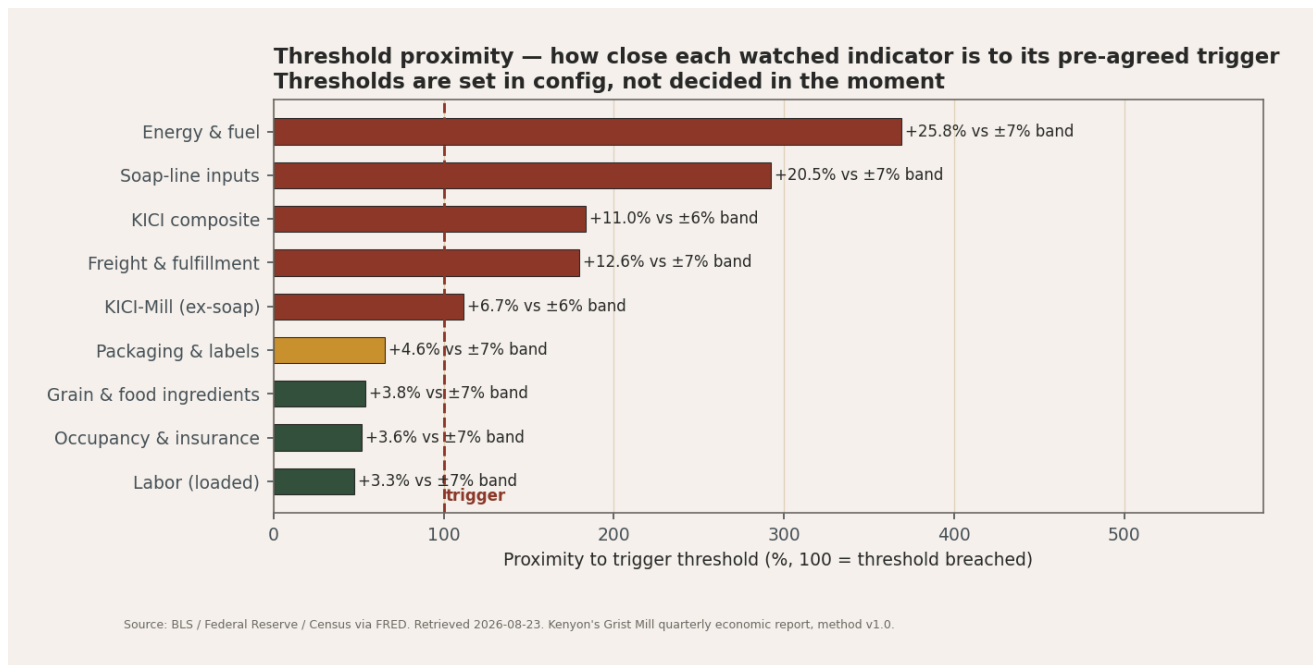
§8 Capital & credit



V8.1 The cost of financing a mill upgrade or delivery vehicle. Prime is the rate a small commercial loan is typically quoted against.

The Fed funds target has been held at **3.50–3.75%**, with prime at **6.75%**. Credit standards for small firms show a net tightening reading of **8**, meaning availability is not currently the binding constraint — price is.

§11 Risk register



V11.2 How close each watched indicator sits to its pre-agreed trigger. Thresholds live in config and are set in advance, not decided in the moment.

§V Data verification

Ten independent checks run against every series before it reaches this report. They exist because the 2026Q2 first pass shipped quarter-over-quarter figures that were arithmetically correct and analytically wrong. The pipeline will not publish while a blocking check fails.

Check	What it tests	Result	Flagged	Status
V1	Cross-source agreement	no overlapping observations to cross-check		WARN
V2	Pinned historical values	all pinned historical values reproduce		PASS
V3	Quarter completeness	every monthly series has all 3 months of 2026Q2	9	WARN
V4	Seasonality	10 of 39 NSA series carry significant seasonality — QoQ for these must use the adjusted path	10	WARN
V5	Change math	no series is using percent change where points are required		INFO
V6	Outliers	0 series moved more than 3σ this quarter		PASS
V7	Revisions	0 revised observations since values-2026-08-23.json		PASS

Check	What it tests	Result	Flagged	Status
V8	Base periods	1 groups require re-indexing; build.py re-bases all of them		INFO
V9	Freshness	0 series beyond expected publication lag		PASS
V10	Config integrity	config, manifest and disk agree on all 81 series		PASS

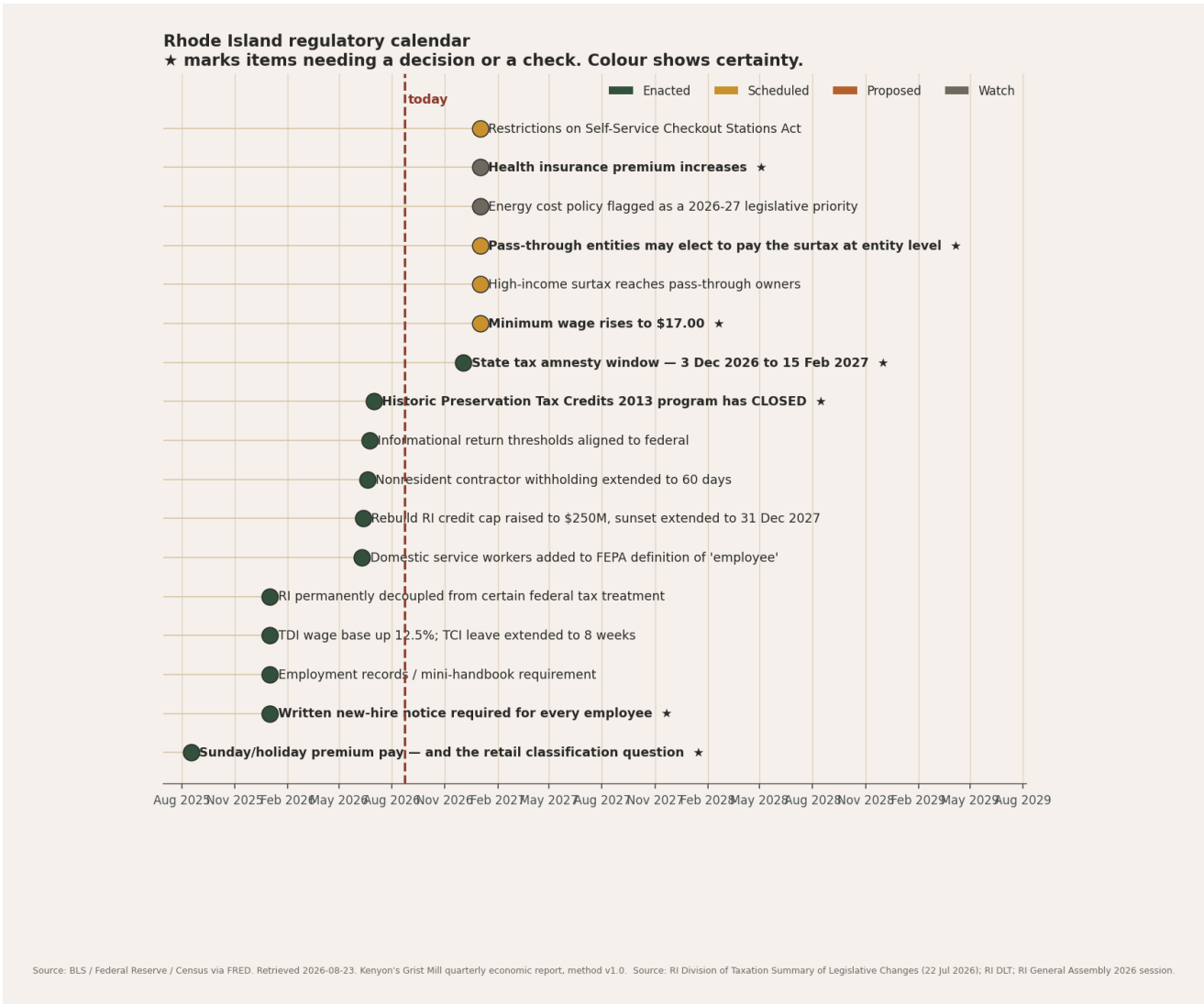
Two corrections applied since the first pass.

1. **Quarter-over-quarter was measuring the season, not the market.** BLS publishes commodity and industry producer prices *not seasonally adjusted*. Ten of our series carry statistically significant seasonality — natural gas swings 10% peak-to-trough on the calendar alone. QoQ figures are now seasonally adjusted using STL decomposition before any comparison; adjusted figures are marked †. Diesel's quarterly move was overstated by 14.6 points. Year-over-year figures were never affected, because twelve months cancels the seasonal factor — which is why the annual numbers held up and the quarterly ones did not.
2. **Percent change was applied to interest rates.** "Prime fell 10%" is not how a rate moves; it fell 0.75 percentage points. For the SLOOS credit-standards series, which crosses zero, percent change is undefined outright — it was reporting +52.8% where the real answer is +2.8 percentage points. Rates and net-balance series now report point differences and are labelled **pp**.

The cross-source check is the backbone: every BLS-sourced observation in 2026Q2 is fetched a second time from the BLS API directly and compared against the FRED value. Disagreement would mean a bad mirror, a stale cache or a wrong series key. This quarter all 129 compared observations agree.

§9 Policy, tax & regulatory

Rules do not arrive as a time series, so this section is a dated register rather than a chart of numbers. The Rhode Island General Assembly adjourned its 2026 session on **11 June 2026**; most of what passed takes effect on **1 January 2027**. Of 19 tracked items, **8 need a decision or a check** — marked ★ below.



V9.1 Every tracked Rhode Island and federal item on a 24-month horizon, coloured by certainty. Enacted items are law; scheduled items are legislated but not yet in effect; watch items are pressure without a date.

9.1 · LABOR & EMPLOYMENT

Item	Effective	Certainty	What it is and why it matters
Minimum wage rises to \$17.00 ★ S 0125 SubA / H 5029 SubA; R.I. Gen. Laws § 28-12-3	2027-01-01	scheduled	\$15.00 (2025) to \$16.00 (1 Jan 2026) to \$17.00 (1 Jan 2027). A 6.25% step on the floor, landing mid-winter when site revenue is at its seasonal low. Why it matters here: Direct, scheduled, unavoidable. Compresses differentials above the floor too. Action: Model 2027 payroll at current headcount and hours before October budgeting.
Sunday/holiday premium pay — and the retail classification question ★	2025-08-17	enacted	Rhode Island is the only state requiring time-and-a-half for Sunday and holiday work independent of overtime. The August 2025 regulation defined "retail business" for the

Item	Effective	Certainty	What it is and why it matters
R.I. Gen. Laws § 5-23-2, § 28-12-4.1(b); DLT reg 260-RICR-30-05-2			first time — and the definition EXCLUDES establishments engaged primarily in manufacturing or wholesale. A retail business may count Sunday/holiday hours toward the 40-hour overtime threshold. A non-retail business must pay both separately ("pyramiding"). Certain agricultural employers are exempt entirely. DLT's authority to grant new exemptions was removed in 2021. Why it matters here: A mill with a retail store, a wholesale book and manufacturing operations could be argued into any of three buckets, and the cost difference between them on a busy autumn Sunday is material. This is the highest-value unresolved question in the register. Action: Determine our classification in writing — retail, non-retail, or agricultural exemption — with counsel or DLT. Then audit whether the last 24 months of Sunday and holiday payroll was calculated on that basis.
Written new-hire notice required for every employee ★ S 0070 SubAaa / H 5679 SubAaa; R.I. Gen. Laws § 28-14-12	2026-01-01	enacted	All employers regardless of size must give each new hire a written, individually tailored notice covering pay rate and basis, allowances, pay period and payday, legal and operating name, and address. Employee must acknowledge receipt; employer must retain the signed copy. Why it matters here: \$400 fine per violation for first and second offences, escalating after. Each affected employee can be a separate violation. Action: Confirm a compliant form exists and is in the onboarding packet. Cheap to fix, expensive to ignore.
Employment records / mini-handbook requirement S 0070 SubAaa / H 5679 SubAaa	2026-01-01	enacted	Expanded record-keeping obligations under the Payment of Wages law. Why it matters here: Administrative. Matters most at audit or on a wage complaint.
TDI wage base up 12.5%; TCI leave extended to 8 weeks S 0974aa / H 6066 SubA	2026-01-01	enacted	TDI taxable wage base rises to \$100,000 (from \$89,200), contribution rate falls to 1.1%, max employee contribution \$1,100. Temporary Caregiver Insurance leave goes from 7 to 8 weeks, max weekly benefit \$1,070. Why it matters here: Employee-funded, so not a direct payroll cost — but 8 weeks of protected leave at a business this size is a coverage and scheduling exposure, not a payroll one.
Menopause added as a protected category under FEPA ★	2025-06-24	enacted	First such mandate in the country. Requires an interactive accommodation process and a posted written notice.

Item	Effective	Certainty	What it is and why it matters
R.I. Fair Employment Practices Act			Why it matters here: Posting and process obligation. Action: Confirm the required notice is posted with the other labor postings.
Domestic service workers added to FEPA definition of 'employee' S 2921 / H 8504; R.I. Gen. Laws § 28-5-6	2026-06-10	enacted	Extends Fair Employment Practices Act coverage to domestic service workers. Why it matters here: Unlikely to apply to this business. Logged for completeness.
Health insurance premium increases ★ RI OHIC annual rate filings; NFIB 2026 session preview	2027-01-01	watch	OHIC reviews and approves small-group rate changes each summer for the following plan year. Why it matters here: Consistently one of the fastest-rising controllable costs for small employers. Action: Check the approved small-group rate change for 2027 when OHIC publishes, before renewal.

The single most valuable question in this report. Rhode Island is the only state requiring time-and-a-half for Sunday and holiday work independent of overtime. In August 2025 the DLT defined “retail business” for the first time — and the definition **excludes establishments engaged primarily in manufacturing or wholesale**. Retail businesses may count Sunday/holiday hours toward the 40-hour overtime threshold; non-retail businesses must pay both separately. Certain agricultural employers are exempt entirely.

A grist mill with a retail store, a wholesale book and a manufacturing operation could be argued into any of the three buckets, and on a busy autumn Sunday the difference between them is real money. Nobody can answer this from a spreadsheet — it needs a written determination from counsel or DLT.

9.2 · TAX

Item	Effective	Certainty	What it is and why it matters
State tax amnesty window — 3 Dec 2026 to 15 Feb 2027 ★ H 7127 Sub A as amended, Article 6 § 1; R.I. Gen. Laws Ch. 44-6.6	2026-12-03 → 2027-02-15	enacted	75-day amnesty for any RI tax administered by the Division of Taxation — personal income, sales and use, corporate — for periods ending on or before 31 Dec 2025. All penalties waived and interest reduced 25%, provided all delinquent returns are filed and the full tax plus 75% of interest is paid within the window. Why it matters here: Opens inside the next reporting quarter. If any sales-and-use or withholding exposure exists

Item	Effective	Certainty	What it is and why it matters
			anywhere in the file, this is the cheapest it will ever be to clear. Action: Ask the accountant one question before December: is there anything outstanding for periods through 2025?
High-income surtax reaches pass-through owners H 7127 Sub A as amended, Article 6 § 5; R.I. Gen. Laws § 44-30-2.6	2027-01-01	scheduled	1% surtax on personal income over \$1 million for TY2027, rising to 2% in TY2028 and 3% in TY2029. Threshold indexed to inflation. Applies to all filing statuses; estates and trusts are subject at a \$36,427 threshold. Why it matters here: Only bites at the owner level above \$1M of personal income. Relevant mainly on a sale or a large distribution year — which makes it an exit-planning input, not an operating one.
Pass-through entities may elect to pay the surtax at entity level ★ H 7127 Sub A as amended, Article 6 § 2; R.I. Gen. Laws § 44-11-2.3	2027-01-01	scheduled	A PTE electing to pay RI income tax at the entity level at the 5.99% top marginal rate may also elect to pay the high-income surtax at entity level, bypassing the federal SALT cap. Why it matters here: Potential federal deduction benefit depending on entity structure and owner income. Action: One question for the accountant during 2026 year-end planning: does our structure make this election worth taking?
Historic Preservation Tax Credits 2013 program has CLOSED ★ RI Division of Taxation, Summary of Legislative Changes, 22 July 2026	2026-06-30	enacted	The 2013 historic preservation credit program's sunset was NOT extended. No credits may be reserved on or after 30 June 2026, while other programs (Rebuild RI, TIF, Qualified Jobs, Wavemaker) were extended to 31 Dec 2027. Why it matters here: Directly relevant to a 300-year-old mill. If any capital work on the historic structure was being planned around this credit, that route closed this quarter. Action: Confirm no planned capital project was relying on this. If one was, re-cost it or look at Rebuild RI instead.
Rebuild RI credit cap raised to \$250M, sunset extended to 31 Dec 2027 H 7127 Sub A as amended, Article 3 § 8	2026-06-12	enacted	Aggregate credit ceiling up from \$225M; program runs a further year. Why it matters here: A live alternative for capital projects now that the historic credit has closed.
Informational return thresholds aligned to	2026-06-23	enacted	State threshold was \$100 for all informational returns; now matches the federal threshold per form type (1099-NEC,

Item	Effective	Certainty	What it is and why it matters
federal H 8604 Sub A / S 3367 Sub A; R.I. Gen. Laws § 44-30-58			1099-INT, etc.). Why it matters here: Small reduction in filing burden for contractor payments.
Nonresident contractor withholding extended to 60 days H 7809 / S 2815; R.I. Gen. Laws § 44-1-6	2026-06-19	enacted	3% of the contract must be withheld for 60 days (was 30) after completion, pending a Certificate of No Tax Due. Division review window also doubled to 60 days. New penalty for non-compliance. Why it matters here: Applies if out-of-state contractors are used for millwork, dam work or building repair.
RI permanently decoupled from certain federal tax treatment H 7127 Sub A as amended, Article 6 §§ 2, 5	2026-01-01	enacted	Permanent decoupling from federal §174A treatment of domestic research and experimental expenditures (TY2026+), §163(j) depreciation/amortization/depletion treatment (TY2027+), and the §1202 exclusion (TY2027+). Why it matters here: State and federal taxable income will diverge. An accountant issue, not an operating one.

9.3 · ENERGY, OPERATIONS & FEDERAL

Item	Effective	Certainty	What it is and why it matters
Energy cost policy flagged as a 2026-27 legislative priority NFIB Rhode Island 2026 session preview	2027-01-01	watch	Energy cost was named a leading issue for the session as New England states reconsider carbon reduction targets. No enacted change yet. Why it matters here: RI commercial power already runs far above the national average — see §4. Rate design changes land straight on the P&L.
Restrictions on Self-Service Checkout Stations Act S 2342 Sub B / H 7290 Sub A	2027-01-01	scheduled	Limits the number of self-service checkout stations a grocery store may operate and the workload of employees monitoring them. Why it matters here: Almost certainly below our scale, but relevant if the store ever adds self-checkout.
FDA Food Traceability Rule (FSMA 204) — compliance 20 July 2028 FDA FSMA § 204(d); 30-month extension	2028-07-20	scheduled	Enhanced recordkeeping and lot-level traceability for foods on the Food Traceability List. Compliance date extended to 20 July 2028. Why it matters here: The federal date is not the binding one. Large retail buyers routinely impose traceability requirements on suppliers well ahead of it — so the real trigger is a customer notice, not the FDA calendar.

Action: Watch for any top-account traceability requirement. That, not 2028, starts the clock.

9.4 · DID NOT PASS — PRESSURE THAT WILL RETURN

Worth tracking because failed bills in Rhode Island are usually re-filed rather than abandoned:

- AI regulation in the workplace
- Electronic monitoring restrictions
- Workplace Psychological Safety Act (bullying) — filed repeatedly
- Expanded caregiver leave
- 32-hour workweek for employers of 500+ (threshold could be lowered later)
- Ban on passing credit-card swipe fees to consumers (MA and CT already prohibit)
- Minimum wage escalation to \$20 by 2030 — original 2025 bill language, expected to return

Register last reviewed 2026-08-22; next review due 2026-11-15. Sources: RI Division of Taxation Summary of Legislative Changes (22 July 2026); RI DLT Labor Standards and regulation 260-RICR-30-05-2; RI General Assembly 2026 session. This is a management summary, not legal or tax advice — the starred items belong with counsel or the accountant.

§12 Next quarter — actions and watch-outs

12.1 · DO THESE BEFORE THE NEXT REPORT

Ordered by dollars at stake, not by ease. Each has an owner line to fill in.

#	Action	Why now	By when	Owner
1	Settle the Sunday/holiday premium classification	RI is the only state with this premium, and the retail definition excludes manufacturing and wholesale. Get a written determination — retail, non-retail, or agricultural exemption — then audit the last 24 months of Sunday and holiday payroll against it. This is the largest unpriced liability in the register.	Oct 2026	_____
2	Re-quote the soap line and decide whether to keep it at this scale	Tallow and inedible fats are up 40% YoY, driven by biodiesel demand rather than anything to do with soap. Combined with the diagnostic's finding that soap is 63.6% of COGS with unknown profitability, this is now both the largest and the most volatile thing the business buys.	Sept 2026	_____

#	Action	Why now	By when	Owner
3	Ask the accountant one question before December	The state tax amnesty runs 3 Dec 2026 – 15 Feb 2027 : penalties waived, interest cut 25%, for any period through 31 Dec 2025. If anything is outstanding anywhere in the file, this is the cheapest it will ever be to clear. The window opens and closes inside the next two reporting quarters.	Nov 2026	_____
4	Model 2027 payroll at the \$17.00 floor	Legislated, certain, and it lands 1 January — mid-winter, when site revenue is at its seasonal low. Include the compression effect on wages currently above the floor, not just those at it.	Oct 2026	_____
5	Start the three collections that do not exist	Contracted grain price per bushel, monthly kWh and therms, and a quarterly shelf-price audit of a dozen competing SKUs. None of these can be downloaded from anywhere. Until they exist this report can tell you what the world costs but not what it costs <i>you</i> per bag.	Ongoing	_____
6	Confirm the January 2026 compliance items are actually done	New-hire written notice (\$400 per violation, each employee a separate violation), records requirement, menopause accommodation posting. Cheap to fix, disproportionately expensive to be caught on.	Sept 2026	_____

12.2 · WATCH-OUTS FOR NEXT QUARTER

FUEL PASS-THROUGH IS NOT FINISHED

Diesel producer prices rose 80% YoY and New England retail diesel sits at **\$5.54/gal**. Freight and packaging indexes lag fuel by roughly one to two quarters, so a meaningful part of this has not reached invoices yet. Expect carrier surcharges and the January parcel rate increase to arrive together.

THE JANUARY STACK

Four things land on or near 1 January 2027 at once: the \$17.00 minimum wage, annual parcel rate increases, health insurance renewal, and the high-income surtax. They arrive in the weakest revenue month of the year. Budget them as one event rather than four.

MARGIN SPREAD — THE ONE TO WATCH

Flour-milling output prices are flat at +0.6% while input costs rise. The spread has fallen 19 points in

four quarters. If it keeps falling, the industry is absorbing rather than passing through, and matching that behaviour means eating the increase. If it turns up, the category has begun to move and there is cover to reprice. Check this first next quarter.

CONSUMER SENTIMENT AT 48

Down 13% YoY and historically weak. A specialty food product at a premium price point is exactly what gets traded down in a weak-sentiment, high-fuel environment. Watch average order value and the site/store mix, not just total revenue.

A CUSTOMER TRACEABILITY REQUEST, NOT THE FDA CALENDAR

FSMA 204 compliance is not due until July 2028, but large retail buyers routinely impose lot-level traceability on suppliers years ahead of the federal date. The trigger is a letter from a top account, not a Federal Register notice. If one arrives, the scoping starts that week.

EIA DATA RUNS A QUARTER BEHIND

State energy figures publish on a longer lag than producer prices, so this quarter's energy numbers are built on two of three months and will revise. Do not act on a single quarter's energy move alone.

12.3 · WHAT IS ON THE CALENDAR

When	What	Type
Sept–Oct 2026	OHIC publishes approved 2027 small-group health rates	Cost input
Oct–Nov 2026	Carriers announce January parcel general rate increases	Cost input
3 Dec 2026	State tax amnesty opens (closes 15 Feb 2027)	Opportunity
1 Jan 2027	Minimum wage to \$17.00; high-income surtax begins; PTE election available; self-checkout act	Enacted
Jan 2027	RI General Assembly reconvenes — expect minimum wage escalation and workplace bullying bills to return	Watch
~7 Nov 2026	Next report: Q3 2026 data complete, publish by day 45	Process

§A Known gaps — not interpolated

The pipeline fails loudly. Where a series could not be retrieved or does not exist, this report shows a gap rather than a filled value.

What's missing	Why	Workaround in use	How to close it
Our contracted flint corn \$/bu	Tier 3 series — does not exist yet; nobody publishes it	None. Commodity corn PPI shown as reference only.	Log each grain purchase: date, grower, bushels, \$/bu, delivered or FOB
Competitive shelf-price ladder	Tier 3 series — requires manual quarterly audit	None	Define a basket of ~12 competing SKUs; photograph shelf prices quarterly
Our kWh, therms, gallons	Internal data not connected	None — bill decomposition chart cannot be produced	Enter 24 months of utility bills once, then quarterly
Published USPS/UPS/FedEx rate schedules	Not machine-readable; annual manual entry	Couriers PPI used as proxy	Enter GRI percentages each January

§B Source manifest

All 70 series, their agency keys, latest observation and staleness at build time.

Key	Series	Source	Last obs	Age	Status
A229RX0	Real disposable income per capita (\$)	BEA via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
APU000072610	Avg electricity price, US city avg (\$/kWh)	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
CPIAUCSL	CPI, all items	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
CUSR0000SAF11	CPI, food at home	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
CUSR0000SAF111	CPI, cereals & bakery products	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
CUUR0000SEFA	CPI, cereals & cereal products	BLS API	2026-07-01	53d	OK
CUUR0000SEFA01	CPI, flour & prepared flour mixes	BLS API	2026-07-01	53d	OK

Key	Series	Source	Last obs	Age	Status
CUUR0000SEFA02	CPI, breakfast cereal	BLS API	2026-07-01	53d	OK
CUUR0000SEHN01	CPI, household cleaning products	BLS API	2026-07-01	53d	OK
DDFUELNYH	ULSD spot, NY Harbor (\$/gal)	EIA via FRED	2026-08-18	5d	OK
DFEDTARU	Fed funds target, upper bound (%)	Federal Reserve via FRED	2026-08-22	1d	OK
DFXARC1M027SBEA	PCE, food & beverages for off-premises consumption (\$B)	BEA via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
DGS10	10-year Treasury yield (%)	Treasury via FRED	2026-08-20	3d	OK
DPRIME	Bank prime loan rate (%)	Federal Reserve via FRED	2026-08-20	3d	OK
DRTSCILM	Net % banks tightening C&I standards, small firms	Federal Reserve SLOOS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
DSPIC96	Real disposable personal income (\$B)	BEA via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
ECIWAG	Employment Cost Index, wages & salaries	BLS via FRED	2026-04-01	144d	OK
ECOMPCTSA	E-commerce share of retail sales (%)	Census via FRED	2026-04-01	144d	OK
ELEC.PRICE.CT-COM.M	Connecticut commercial electricity price (cents/kWh)	EIA Electric Power Monthly	2026-05-01	Noned	OK
ELEC.PRICE.MA-COM.M	Massachusetts commercial electricity price (cents/kWh)	EIA Electric Power Monthly	2026-05-01	Noned	OK
ELEC.PRICE.NEW-COM.M	New England commercial electricity price (cents/kWh)	EIA Electric Power Monthly	2026-05-01	Noned	OK
ELEC.PRICE.RI-ALL.M	RI all-sector electricity price (cents/kWh)	EIA Electric Power Monthly	2026-05-01	Noned	OK
ELEC.PRICE.RI-COM.M	RI commercial electricity price (cents/kWh)	EIA Electric Power Monthly	2026-05-01	Noned	OK
ELEC.PRICE.RI-IND.M	RI industrial electricity price (cents/kWh)	EIA Electric Power Monthly	2026-05-01	Noned	OK

Key	Series	Source	Last obs	Age	Status
ELEC.PRICE.US-COM.M	US commercial electricity price (cents/kWh)	EIA Electric Power Monthly	2026-05-01	Noned	OK
ELEC.SALES.RI-COM.M	RI commercial electricity sales (million kWh)	EIA Electric Power Monthly	2026-05-01	Noned	OK
EMD_EPD2D_PTE_R1X_DPG	New England (PADD 1A) No. 2 diesel retail (\$/gal)	EIA Weekly Retail Gasoline and Diesel Prices	2026-08-17	Noned	OK
EMM_EPMR_PTE_R1X_DPG	New England (PADD 1A) regular gasoline retail (\$/gal)	EIA Weekly Retail Gasoline and Diesel Prices	2026-08-17	Noned	OK
IPG3112S	Industrial production, grain & oilseed milling	Federal Reserve via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
IPG311S	Industrial production, food manufacturing	Federal Reserve via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
IPG3256S	Industrial production, soap & cleaning compounds	Federal Reserve via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
MORTGAGE30US	30-yr fixed mortgage rate (%)	Freddie Mac via FRED	2026-08-20	3d	OK
MRTSSM4451USS	Retail sales, grocery stores (\$M)	Census via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
MRTSSM445USS	Retail sales, food & beverage stores (\$M)	Census via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
MRTSSM454USS	Retail sales, nonstore retailers (\$M)	Census via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
MRTSSM722USS	Retail sales, food services & drinking places (\$M)	Census via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
N3020RI3	RI natural gas price, commercial (\$/mcf)	EIA Natural Gas Monthly	2026-05-15	Noned	OK
PCU311211311211	PPI, flour milling (NAICS 311211)	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PCU311230311230	PPI, breakfast cereal mfg	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PCU322211322211	PPI, corrugated box manufacturing	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK

Key	Series	Source	Last obs	Age	Status
PCU325611325611	PPI, soap & other detergent mfg	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PCU326111326111	PPI, plastics bag & pouch mfg	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PCU484121484121	PPI, long-distance TL trucking	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PCU484122484122	PPI, long-distance LTL trucking	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PCU492110492110	PPI, couriers & express delivery	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PCU493110493110	PPI, general warehousing & storage	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PCU524126524126	PPI, direct property & casualty insurers	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
PPIFIS	PPI final demand	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
RILEIH	RI leisure & hospitality employment (000s)	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
RILEIHN	RI leisure & hospitality employment, NSA (000s)	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
RILF	RI civilian labor force	BLS via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
RIMFG	RI manufacturing employment (000s)	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
RIUR	RI unemployment rate (%)	BLS via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK
SMU44000000500000003	RI avg hourly earnings, private (\$)	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
SMU44000003000000003	RI avg hourly earnings, manufacturing (\$)	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
T10YIE	10-yr breakeven inflation rate (%)	Federal Reserve via FRED	2026-08-21	2d	OK
UMCSENT	U. Michigan consumer sentiment	U. Michigan via FRED	2026-06-01	83d	OK

Key	Series	Source	Last obs	Age	Status
WPU012	PPI, grains	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU01220205	PPI, corn	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU021	PPI, cereal & bakery products	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU0212	PPI, flour & flour base mixes	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU021203	PPI, wheat flour	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU021204	PPI, flour base mixes & doughs	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU023	PPI, dairy products	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU025	PPI, sugar & confectionery	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU027	PPI, fats & oils	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU0278	PPI, shortening & cooking oils	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU0531	PPI, natural gas	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU0542	PPI, commercial electric power	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU057303	PPI, No. 2 diesel fuel	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU061	PPI, industrial chemicals	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU0641	PPI, fats & oils, inedible	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU06410132	PPI, lard, inedible tallow & grease	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU0671	PPI, soaps & detergents	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU0722	PPI, unsupported plastic film & sheet	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK

Key	Series	Source	Last obs	Age	Status
WPU0915	PPI, converted paper & paperboard	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU09150301	PPI, corrugated shipping containers	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU0947	PPI, commercial printing (labels)	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPU1381	PPI, glass containers	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPUID61	Processed goods, intermediate demand	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK
WPUID62	Unprocessed goods, intermediate demand	BLS via FRED	2026-07-01	53d	OK

§C Works cited

Every source used to produce this report, generated from the fetch manifest so it cannot drift from the data actually used. Data series are cited in the format requested by the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis for FRED redistribution and by BLS for its public API: originating agency, series title, series identifier, access route, URL, and retrieval date. Originating agencies are credited individually — FRED and the BLS API are delivery platforms, not sources.

70 data series · 18 documentary sources · all retrieved 2026-08-23

PART A — DATA SERIES

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- 1. U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics.** *Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: All Items in U.S. City Average* [CPIAUCSL], retrieved from FRED, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis; <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/CPIAUCSL>, August 23, 2026.
Latest observation 2026-07-01.
- 2. U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics.** *Producer Price Index by Commodity: Final Demand* [PPIFIS], retrieved from FRED, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis; <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/PPIFIS>, August 23, 2026.
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MILLING INDUSTRY OUTPUT PRICES

5. **U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics.** *Producer Price Index by Commodity: Processed foods and feeds: Cereal and bakery products* [WPU021], retrieved from FRED, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis; <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/WPU021>, August 23, 2026.
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Latest observation 2026-07-01.

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PACKAGING, LABELS AND SHIPPING MATERIALS

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FREIGHT, PARCEL AND WAREHOUSING

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SOAP-LINE INPUTS

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OCCUPANCY, INSURANCE AND SERVICES

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LABOR AND WAGES

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CAPITAL, CREDIT AND INTEREST RATES

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- 46. Freddie Mac. 30-Year Fixed Rate Mortgage Average in the United States** [MORTGAGE30US], retrieved from FRED, Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis; <https://fred.stlouisfed.org/series/MORTGAGE30US>, August 23, 2026.
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CONSUMER DEMAND BACKDROP

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MARKET DEMAND FOR OUR PRODUCT CATEGORIES

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PART B — DOCUMENTARY SOURCES

METHODOLOGY AND SERIES DEFINITIONS

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<https://www.bls.gov/opub/hom/ppi/>
Used for: Definitions of the industry, commodity and FD-ID index families; revision policy; treatment of discounts and freight.
- 72. U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. Producer Price Index code tables: wp.series, wp.item, wp.group (commodity) and pc.industry (industry).** BLS public time-series files.
<https://download.bls.gov/pub/time.series/wp/>
Used for: Used to verify every PPI series key against its official commodity or industry name before inclusion. Several plausible-looking codes decode to unrelated commodities.
- 73. U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. Consumer Price Index code table: cu.item.** BLS public time-series files.
<https://download.bls.gov/pub/time.series/cu/>
Used for: Used to identify the CPI item codes for flour and prepared flour mixes, cereals, and household cleaning products.
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<https://www.bls.gov/developers/>
Used for: Source for CPI item-level series not mirrored on FRED. Note the ten-year request window; requests exceeding it are truncated without error.
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Used for: Aggregation and delivery platform for the majority of series used. Originating agencies are cited individually above.
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<https://www.federalreserve.gov/releases/g17/>
Used for: Basis for the category volume measures used in the market demand section.

LABOR LAW AND WAGE POLICY — RHODE ISLAND

- 77. Rhode Island Department of Labor and Training. "Minimum Wage." R.I. Gen. Laws § 28-12.**
<https://dlt.ri.gov/regulation-and-safety/labor-standards/minimum-wage>
Used for: Statutory wage schedule: \$16.00 effective January 1, 2026; \$17.00 effective January 1, 2027.
- 78. Rhode Island General Assembly. 2025-H 5029A / 2025-S 0125A, An Act Relating to Labor and Labor Relations — Minimum Wages.** Signed August 4, 2025.
<https://webserver.rilegislature.gov/BillText/BillText25/HouseText25/H5029A.pdf>
Used for: Enacting legislation for the 2026–2027 minimum wage schedule.
- 79. Rhode Island Department of Labor and Training. Sunday and holiday premium pay requirements, R.I. Gen. Laws § 25-3.**

<https://dlt.ri.gov/regulation-and-safety/labor-standards>

Used for: Rhode Island is the only state retaining a general Sunday and holiday premium pay requirement — a material cost for a weekend-traffic retail site that no national wage series captures.

FOOD SAFETY AND REGULATORY

- 80.** U.S. Food and Drug Administration. "FSMA Final Rule on Requirements for Additional Traceability Records for Certain Foods." 21 C.F.R. Part 1, Subpart S. Published November 21, 2022.

<https://www.fda.gov/food/food-safety-modernization-act-fsma/fsma-final-rule-requirements-additional-traceability-records-certain-foods>

Used for: Compliance date moved from January 20, 2026 to July 20, 2028.

- 81.** U.S. Food and Drug Administration. "Requirements for Additional Traceability Records for Certain Foods: Compliance Date Extension." 90 Fed. Reg. (August 7, 2025).

<https://www.federalregister.gov/documents/2025/08/07/2025-14967/requirements-for-additional-traceability-records-for-certain-foods-compliance-date-extension>

Used for: Proposed thirty-month extension of the Food Traceability Rule compliance date.

- 82.** Continuing Appropriations, Agriculture, Legislative Branch, Military Construction and Veterans Affairs, and Extensions Act, 2026. Pub. L. (November 2025).

<https://www.congress.gov/>

Used for: Congressional directive that FDA not enforce the Food Traceability Rule before July 20, 2028.

MONETARY POLICY

- 83.** Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System. "Federal Reserve issues FOMC statement." June 17, 2026.

<https://www.federalreserve.gov/newsevents/pressreleases/monetary20260617a.htm>

Used for: Federal funds target range held at 3.50–3.75 percent; Committee attributes elevated inflation in part to supply shocks in energy.

- 84.** Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System. "Selected Interest Rates — H.15." Statistical Release.

<https://www.federalreserve.gov/releases/h15/>

Used for: Prime rate and Treasury constant-maturity yields.

- 85.** Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System. "Senior Loan Officer Opinion Survey on Bank Lending Practices."

<https://www.federalreserve.gov/data/sloos.htm>

Used for: Credit availability for small firms.

INTERNAL SOURCES

- 86.** Kenyon's Grist Mill. Business Diagnostic, seven-tier assessment.

Used for: Source of the cost-structure findings referenced throughout, including soap at 63.6 percent of COGS, 47.0 percent blended gross margin, and the unattributed revenue share. Provides the provisional group weights used in the input cost index.

- 87.** Kenyon's Grist Mill. Quarterly Economic Environment Report — Outline and Automation Specification, version 0.1.

Used for: Specification this pipeline implements. Defines section structure, index construction, threshold bands and visual standards.

- 88.** Kenyon's Grist Mill. Brand colour system, fourteen-colour palette with usage and accessibility rules.

Used for: Chart and report styling. Johnny Cake Gold is reserved throughout for Kenyon's own series in any comparison.

Kenyon's Grist Mill quarterly economic environment report · method version 1.0 · generated 2026-08-23T10:58:00+00:00 · data from the U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Federal Reserve Board, U.S. Census Bureau and Bureau of Economic Analysis, retrieved via the Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis (FRED).

Series keys verified against BLS `wp.series`, `wp.item`, `wp.group` and `pc.industry` code tables. Producer price indexes measure prices received by sellers and exclude freight, tariffs and volume-tier discounts; they indicate the direction of future quotes rather than costs already paid. PPI figures are revised approximately four months after first publication. Index base periods differ between series and are re-based to a common quarter before any comparison.

This report describes the external operating environment. It is not financial advice and does not substitute for the internal business diagnostic, which reads the books.